API gateway or other client to exchange an access token for a JWT or other security token. As well as allowing the client to request a new token, the AS may also add an `"act"` claim to the resulting token that indicates that the service client is acting on behalf of the user that is identified as the subject of the token. A backend service can then identify both the service client and the user that initiated the request originally from a single access token.

> **DEFINITION** Token exchange should primarily be used for ***delegation semantics***, in which one party acts on behalf of another but both are clearly identified. It can also be used for ***impersonation***, in which the backend service is unable to tell that another party is impersonating the user. You should prefer delegation whenever possible because impersonation leads to misleading audit logs and loss of accountability.

To request a token exchange, the client makes a HTTP POST request to the AS's token endpoint, just as for other authorization grants. The `grant_type` parameter is set to `urn:ietf:params:oauth:grant-type:token-exchange`, and the client passes a token representing the user's initial authority as the `subject_token` parameter, with a `subject_token_type` parameter describing the type of token (token exchange allows a variety of tokens to be used, not just access tokens). The client authenticates to the token endpoint using its own credentials and can provide several optional parameters shown in table 11.4. The AS will make an authorization decision based on the supplied information